philosophy is not apparent from a distance—most scientists have never heard of the analytic-Continental divide. So, given that most of the highly visible philosophers in the public sphere today are Continental, and given the attitude that some (not all) Continental philosophers have toward science, it's not terribly surprising that scientists often have disdain for *all* philosophers, and sometimes even think that they can do philosophy better than the philosophers can.

But there's more to it than this. Not all physicists who support the Copenhagen interpretation are merely ignorant of philosophy. Zeilinger has spent a great deal of time at conferences on quantum foundations with philosophers of physics and is certainly aware of the history of positivism in his native Vienna. And it's not as if a deep commitment to positivism among a wide swath of physicists is driving support of the Copenhagen interpretation—if anything, it's the opposite. We physicists all learn some form of the Copenhagen interpretation in school, and many of us adopt it. And once you have that Copenhagen mindset, you'll probably be more favorably inclined toward positivism and related views. So perhaps it's not that physicists are eager to adopt positions that absolve them of responsibility for talking about reality—perhaps it's merely that such positions become appealing once you've adopted Copenhagen's viewpoint. Which leaves us back where we started: What's so appealing about the Copenhagen interpretation?

"If I were forced to sum up in one sentence what the Copenhagen interpretation says to me," wrote the physicist David Mermin in 1989, "it would be 'Shut up and calculate!'" Mermin followed his summary with a quick rejoinder—"But I won't shut up." Yet the phrase "shut up and calculate" took on a life of its own after Mermin set it to paper, and rapidly became the catchphrase of the Copenhagen interpretation among physicists. It was misattributed to Richard Feynman, and eventually even Mermin himself forgot where it came from, only to rediscover, years later, that he was the source of the phrase.

"Shut up and calculate!" certainly doesn't sound appealing if you're not